

PROJECT REPORT

- **What Surprised Me the Most**

Honestly, before starting this project, I thought only careless or uneducated people fell for online scams. That belief was completely shattered. While researching UPI fraud, I found out that even working professionals, teachers, and tech-savvy people have lost money to these tricks. The scams are not simple anymore — fraudsters study human psychology, use fake government IDs, and speak very confidently to sound trustworthy. The most shocking part was learning that entering your UPI PIN on a 'collect request' actually sends money — not receives it. This one small detail has cost thousands of people their hard-earned savings. I never knew this, and I realised I could have easily been tricked too.

"It is not about being smart or dumb. Anyone can be fooled when they are in a hurry, under pressure, or simply not aware of how the trick works."

- **One Habit I Will Personally Change**

I used to connect to public Wi-Fi at my college canteen and nearby cafes without a second thought — sometimes even checking my bank account or making UPI payments on it. After learning that hackers can easily spy on unsecured networks, I am going to stop doing this completely. From now on, I will only use my mobile data for anything related to payments, banking, or logging into important accounts. It is a small change, but it could protect me from a very big problem. This research did not just give me information — it gave me a genuine reason to be more careful every single day.